

Hrishikesh Nanda

Product designer

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Product Designer specializing in systems-level UX, onboarding architecture, developer tooling, and AI-led autonomous interfaces. Proven track record owning complex products end-to-end at scale (10M+ registered users) — bridging deep backend system behavior, regulatory constraints, and high-precision visual interfaces. Combines design craftsmanship from IIT Guwahati with AI-driven product engineering and hands-on mechanical and hardware systems tinkering

EXPERIENCE

Upstox · Product Designer

2022 — 2023 · Bangalore

One of India's largest retail stock broking platforms — the Robinhood equivalent for the Indian market — with 10M+ registered users and roughly 3M active traders at the time.

NAO 2.0, Native Account Opening

Aug 2022 — Feb 2023

- **Redesigned Upstox's account opening, end to end** — signup through to e-sign, on Android, iOS and web. Audited drop-off/rejection data across the funnel (losing ~60% of leads, 35% post-submission rejections, 40% requiring sales calls).
- **Modular System Architecture:** Rebuilt six core blocks (Email SSO, PAN, Bank Verification, Liveness Photo, Signature, E-sign). Specced a backend 'Templates & Blocks' CMS architecture, enabling PMs to configure flows and match thresholds remotely without code releases.
- **Automated Verification Integrations:** Integrated single-tap Apple Sign-In (iOS) and Google SSO (**+4.9%** step lift), real-time HyperVerge Liveness SDK (photo rejection dropped from 18.5% to 1.0%), and Setu UPI Reverse Penny Drop for instant bank verification.
- **Friction Reduction & Signature Canvas:** Designed landscape digital signature canvas with animated priming guide and zero-state reset policy (slashing 21.3% signature rejection rate). Cut mandatory manual inputs from 15 to 9 and document uploads from 3 to 0.

Up.alert Notification Dashboard — sole designer

Nov — Dec 2022

- **Internal Communication Platform:** Designed the internal web dashboard enabling marketing and content teams to broadcast push notifications and in-app alert banners to 10M+ users without engineering dependency.
- **Safety & Crisis Guardrails:** Built essential fail-safes into the UI: permanent test-vs-production environment indicators, mandatory Test_ audience prefixing, real-time audience verification counts before send, and pause/resume controls for live warning banners.
- **Analytics & Targeting:** Designed CSV audience targeting supporting dynamic \$variable placeholders and an integrated Mixpanel analytics view (sends, deliveries, clicks) that doubles as an audit trail.

Invest Logos — design lead

2022

- **Visual Craftsmanship at Scale:** Led the initiative to introduce stock logos in Upstox Lite — a first among Indian brokerages where exchanges publish plain text. Established visual style guidelines, small-scale legibility standards, fallback rules, and SVG vector requirements.
- **Team Direction & Delivery:** Directed a team of 5–10 junior designers and interns, producing and shipping ~2,180 vector logos integrated into the live app.

Account Centre and Developer API Console

July — September 2022

- **Responsive Shell Architecture:** Designed the structural web shell for Account Centre before touching product screens — defining grid systems (SM/LG breakpoints), top-bar navigation rules, scroll pinning, and every loading, empty, 404, and error state
- **Developer API Console:** Owned full UI design for third-party developer API management. Designed app creation, plan subscriptions, wallet billing around async API behavior, a dedicated self-serve sandbox environment, error state UX, and SEBI multi-factor login compliance (OTP + PIN).

Ani! · Co-founder and Founding Designer

2023 — 2024

- **0-to-1 Mobile Creation:** Designed the anime social platform Ani! (iOS & Android) originating from a MyAnimeList UI redesign concept. Partnered with technical co-founder to ship watchlist tracking, fan art UGC publishing, real-time chatrooms, and social feeds

Trophee · Lead UI Designer, freelance

2021 — 2022 · Singapore

- **Manga Reader & WebApp:** Sole designer for Singapore Web3 manga platform. Designed visual identity, mascot, design system, and a multi-directional reader supporting 4 reading directions across Manga, Manhwa, and Manhua
- **Launched in alpha on web in April 2022**, carrying the mobile designs across without a redesign.

INDEPENDENT WORK · 2026

- **Mobile Accessibility Agent:** Conceived and designed an AI-driven Android accessibility product enabling visually and motor-impaired users to execute multi-step native app tasks. Built on accessibility tree parsing, multi-tier safety gates (Silent, Announce, Halt), and non-visual press-and-hold haptic confirmation loops. — concept and prototype
- **Agentic OS & Server Control Plane:** An autonomous server fleet control plane and trust layer. Designed natural language intent-to-policy translation, multi-stage approval gates ('The agent proposes, policy consents'), transaction ledgers, and automated rollback guardrails operating alongside enterprise Linux distros. — concept and demo

SYSTEMS, HARDWARE & AUTOMOTIVE ENGINEERING

NikOttO Pvt. Ltd. · ECU Calibration & Engineering

2025

- **Hardware & Electronic Calibration:** Engine Control Unit (ECU) electronic calibration and sensor tuning at an IIT Madras-incubated automotive startup — gaining hands-on expertise in low-level electronic hardware, diagnostics, and sensor telemetry.
- **Automotive Restoration & OE-Plus Engineering:** Hands-on mechanical builder with a strict 'fix over replace' philosophy. Rebuilt engine mounts, head gasket, intake, and exhaust on a Suzuki SY416; resurrected a seized auction Honda CBR250R over 3 months; pursuing turbo tuning on a 2011 Skoda Laura.
- **Low-Level Systems & Firmware:** Compiled custom Android OS binaries and custom recoveries (2011–2013); runs Arch Linux across all personal hardware; restores and tinkers with legacy laptop/PC hardware systems.
- **Other random things about me:** Plays a bit of Valorant and does occasional Elden Ring speedruns (sub-2 hour completion, Level 1 hitless boss runs etc)

SKILLS

Figma · Design Systems & Componentry · Data Visualisation · State & Edge-Case Design · Native iOS/Android UI Patterns · System Architecture (Templates & Blocks) · Hardware-Software Interactions · HTML, CSS, JavaScript · SQL · Arch Linux · Git · LLM & Agent Tooling

EDUCATION

B.Des, Indian Institute of Technology Guwahati · 2018 — 2022

VOLUNTEERING

Broseph Foundation · 2024 — 2026

Social work and charitable organisation. Supported efforts to report and address privacy violations against women online. Volunteered at orphanages — donated food and clothing, and spent time directly with the children. City clean-up initiatives.